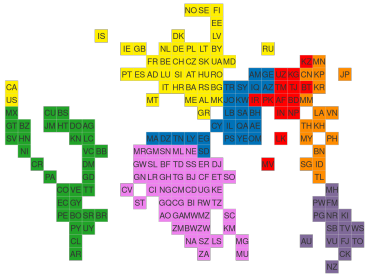

Daniel Capistrano

Social Researcher

Contact

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Formal education

PhD Social Sciences

University of Brasilia (2013)

Thesis about values and attitudes towards the role of the State in Latin America. Avg. grade: 97%. Recognised student at the University of Oxford (UK) (2012/13)

Certificate Data Science

University of Toronto (2025)

Course designed for professionals migrating to the Data Science industry. Avg. grade: 93%

BSc Sociology

University of Brasilia (2006)

Internship teaching at a secondary school. Specialisation in research methods and education policy. Avg. grade: 84%

I am a social researcher interested in diverse topics such as public policy, social equality and research methods. For more than 10 years, I have been collaborating in academia and government with statisticians, data scientists and policy makers to produce information and knowledge with high social impact.

Experience

Researcher — 2025 / present

The Economic and Social Research Institute

As a career research officer, I am responsible for conducting social research on inclusion, equality and discrimination.

Researcher — 2023 / 2024

UCD Geary Institute for Public Policy

Working directly with the PI of the Horizon Europe project EqualStrength, I coordinated research teams working across eight European countries investigating cumulative and structural forms of discrimination.

Assistant Professor — 2021 / 2022

UCD School of Education

I taught graduate and undergraduate modules on Research Methods and Development Education. I also worked in mixed methods research projects in Ireland and Sierra Leone, producing quantitative data analyses and reports

Postdoc Researcher — 2018 / 2021

UCD Geary Institute for Public Policy

I was responsible for supervising the data collection, analyses and reporting of the European Social Survey in Ireland.

Researcher — 2008 / 2017

Ministry of Education

I coordinated the provision of Brazilian educational data to international organisations. I also managed the Ministry's participation in UNESCO, OECD, OEI and Unicef projects related to education statistics in Brazil.

Research assistant — 2006 / 2007

Public Opinion Research Center - DATAUnB

Fieldwork manager of the team evaluating the National Youth Inclusion Programme (Projovem)

Teaching experience

- Education for sustainable futures - University College Dublin (2021/23)
- Development education - University College Dublin (2020/22)
- Research Methods 1 - University College Dublin (2021/22)
- Research Methods 2 - University College Dublin (2021/22)
- Philosophy of Education - University College Dublin (2021)
- Inequality in Irish Society - University College Dublin (2018/19)*
- Quantitative Data Analytics - University College Dublin (2018)*

Languages

- Portuguese (native)
- English (fluent)
- Spanish (proficient)

Research skills

- Content analysis ★
- Dataviz (ggplot) ★★★
- Interviewing ★★
- Machine learning ★
- Mixed methods ★★
- Python ★★★
- Questionnaire Design ★★
- R / Tidyverse ★★★
- Statistics / Inference ★★★
- Survey data analysis ★★★

Membership

- European Consortium for Social Research (ECSR)
- International Migration Research Network (IMISCOE)
- International Sociological Association (RC55)

- Political theory - Brasilia University Center (2014/15)

Project management

Researcher — 2026 / current
Research Programme on Integration, Migration and Equality (RIME)

I am involved in the coordination of research projects related to inclusion and integration in Ireland funded by the Department of Justice, Home Affairs and Migration.

Deputy Principal Investigator — 2016 / 2024
World Values Survey

I was involved in the administration of the WVS in Brazil from wave 5 until wave 7. I participated in the funding application, managed the questionnaire translation and adaptation,as well as data analyses.

Co-Principal Investigator — 2021 / 2023
University Climate Change Challenge

Together with two colleagues, we secured funding and conducted a research on attitudes and knowledge about climate change among university students.

Postdoc researcher — 2020 / 2021
Safe Learning

Supervised the data collection of a longitudinal randomised control trial in Sierra Leone and worked in the data processing and analysis

Postdoc researcher — 2018 / 2020
European Social Survey

Collaborated in the planning and sample design of the Irish fieldwork. Supervised data collection and worked in the data processing and analysis

National Project Manager — 2011 / 2014
OECD Teaching and Learning International Survey

Managed pilot, questionnaire design and translation, training, fieldwork and data processing for the 2013 round in Brazil

Consultant — 2018 / 2021
Monitoring of the SDG4

I participated in the data analysis and preparation of several publications related to the SDG4 for the UNESCO Institute for Statistics since 2018.

Selected publications

Economic and Social Research Institute (2026)
Public support for welfare and redistributive policies in Ireland (with Russell H, Maitre B)

Debates en Sociología (2025)
El medioambiente como objeto político (with Vizcarra S, Santos M)

References

Full Prof. Henrique Castro

University of Rio Grande do Sul

PhD Supervisor and research collaborator

henrique@ufrgs.br

Assoc. Prof. Mat Creighton

University College Dublin

Former line manager

mathew.creighton@ucd.ie

Research Professor Helen Russell

Economic and Social Research Institute

Current line manager

helen.russell@esri.ie

SocArXiv (2025)
Ethnic and gender bias in Large Language Models across contexts (with Creighton M, Fernández-Reino M)

Scientific Data (2025)
The Perception of Names in Experimental Studies on Ethnic Origin: A Cross-National Validation in Europe (with Ghekiere A, Martiniello B, Kuhnle J, Sprong S, Atay P, Cebolla Boado H, Creighton M, Di Stasio V, Fernández-Reino M, Hildebrandt J, Ketevani K, Lachkovska V, Lancee B, Bueno IL, Montag J, Simonovits B, Steinmetz S, Strömberg S, Suárez-Vergne A, van Oosten S, Vass-Vigh V, Veit S, Zschirnt E, Verhaeghe P)

In: The Global Politics of Census Taking: (2024)
Education Censuses and Recognition: The Politics of Collecting and Using Data on Indigenous Students in Latin America (with Carvalho C, Rabelo R)

Social Indicators Research (2024)
'I guess we are from very different backgrounds': Attitudes towards Social Justice and Intergenerational Educational Mobility in European Societies (with Creighton M, Iskli E)

Cambridge Journal of Education (2024)
The COVID-19 pandemic and childrens engagement with learning in rural Sierra Leone (with Smith A, Devine D, Samonova E, Sugrue C, Sloan S, Symonds J, Gibbons R, Folan A)

Behavioral SciencesBehavioral Sciences (2024)
Teacher Violence and Student Wellbeing in Rural Sierra Leone: Longitudinal Dynamics Across Primary Schooling (with D'Urso G, Symonds J, Sloan S, Samonova E, Devine D, Sugrue C)

Journal of International Migration and Integration (2023)
Educational Mobility and Attitudes toward Immigration from an International Comparative Perspective (with Creighton M, Pedrosa E)

Journal of Educational Change (2023)
Anatomy of An Educational Change: The Safe Learning Model, Sierra Leone (with Sugrue C, Samonova E, Devine D, Sloan S, Symonds J, Smith A)

Children and Society (2023)
Picturing safety and danger: Children's perspectives in rural Sierra Leone (with Samonova E, Devine D, Smith A, Sugrue C, Sloan S, Symonds J)

Spanish Journal of Comparative Education (2022)
National Reports and Global Education Policy Diffusion: The case of the Teaching and Learning International Survey (with Carvalho C)

Survey Research: Insights from the field (2022)
The effect of advance letters on survey participation: The case of Ireland and the European Social Survey (with Creighton M)

Journal of Aggression, Conflict and Peace Research (2022)
Assessing experiences with violence and peace in primary schools in Sierra Leone (with Sloan S, Symonds J, Devine D, Sugrue C, Samonova E)

Comparative Sociology (2022)
Statistical innovation in the Global South: Mechanisms of Translation in Censuses of Brazil, Ecuador, Ghana and Sierra Leone (with Villacis B, Thiel A, Carvalho C)

Spatial Demography (2021)
Physical Spacing and Social Interaction Before the Global Pandemic (with Creighton M, Sorokowska A, Sorokowski P)

Journal of Happiness Studies (2021)
Developing a Social Evolutionary Measure of Child and Adolescent Hedonic and Eudaimonic Wellbeing in Rural Sierra Leone (with Symonds J, Sloan S, Kearns M, Devine D, Sugrue C, Suryanaryan S, Samonova E)

Revista USP (2021)
Valores morais e de auto expressão: pós-materialismo em/na crise? (with Castro HCO, Vizcarra S)

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